by the group swayed public opinion and halted the tests. This was the first action of what was to become Greenpeace, an organization that continues to use direct action to challenge those engaged in environmentally damaging activities.



Activists in a dinghy patrol in front of two ships from the UK carrying illegal toxic substances as part of regular Greenpeace protests.

Green politics

During the 1970s, political parties with dedicated environmentalist manifestos emerged in several countries. For example, The Ecology Party was established in the UK in 1975, and the Green Party formed in Germany in 1979. As the movement gained momentum, many smaller parties began to coalesce to form national, unified Green Parties.